

The Capex Tax

WEEK ENDING FRI 24 JUL 2026
COMPILED SAT 25 JUL • 61 SOURCES

Three companies beat earnings this week and were sold anyway. Alphabet, Intel and Texas Instruments each cleared the bar on revenue and profit, then raised what they intend to spend — and the market marked all three down. The buyers went where the spending lands: servers, memory, power. The sellers went where the spending comes from.

S&P 500	NASDAQ COMP
7,411.98	24,975.82
+0.05% Fri • -0.6% wk	-0.64% Fri • -2.0% wk
DOW JONES	WTI CRUDE
51,947.25	\$89.31
+0.48% Fri • only index up	-3.1% Fri • +30% MTD
US 10-YEAR	BITCOIN
4.67%	~\$63.9k
high since Jan 2025	+9% in July

Top 10 movers, up and down

bars share one scale, 0–90%

▲ Ten biggest advances			28–24 JUL
01	UTZ Utz Brands	\$14.06	+89.2%
TUE 21 • Taken private by Intersnack Group in a \$2.9bn deal. The week's only true one-off — a closed-end event, not a trend.			
02	SMCI Super Micro Computer	\$31.20	+25.0%
TUE-WED • Over \$60bn of new Q4 orders, record backlog, and gross-margin guidance lifted from 8.2–8.4% to 15–17%. Plans an AI data centre with SpaceX.			
03	ACHR Archer Aviation	\$5.28	+22.0%
MON 20 • Defence-tech partnership; the single largest one-day move of Monday's session.			
04	NBIS Nebius Group	\$216.92	+18.9%
TUE 21 • Nvidia disclosed a 9.3% stake in the neocloud — ~22.3m shares, tracing to a \$2bn March investment. Analyst targets followed.			
05	MU Micron Technology	\$913.53	+12.0%
TUE 21 • Memory melt-up: WDC and STX each rose about the same, the DRAM ETF +11%. Round-tripped by Friday — see below.			
06	COIN Coinbase	n/a	+9.6%
TUE 21 • Bitcoin hit its highest since 16 June on CLARITY Act optimism and a fifth straight day of spot-ETF inflows.			
07	WULF TeraWulf	\$19.92	+8.0%
TUE 21 • Carried up in the same crypto-equity bid as COIN and HOOD.			
08	NOW ServiceNow	\$91.94	+7.3%
THU 23 • EPS \$0.90 vs \$0.85–0.86 est, subscription revenue +23%, FY guidance raised, AI ACV past \$1bn. A rare beat that was actually paid for.			
09	HOOD Robinhood	\$106.36	+7.1%
TUE 21 • Crypto-linked bid; closed at \$106.36.			
10	HAS Hasbro	n/a	+7.0%
TUE 21 • Q2 beat on both lines, FY adjusted EBITDA guidance raised.			

▼ Ten biggest declines			28–24 JUL
01	LESL Leslie's	\$1.31	-47.0%
WED 22 • Weighing Chapter 11. About \$757m of debt against \$61m FY25 adjusted EBITDA — roughly 12.5× leverage. Down over 99% since its 2020 IPO.			
02	ACI Albertsons	\$11.02	-22.0%
THU 23 • EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.54 est and FY26 guidance cut to \$1.75–1.85 from \$2.22–2.32. Identical sales flipped to a decline. Losing low-income shoppers to Walmart, Amazon and Aldi.			
03	PEGA Pegasystems	\$26.24	-16.7%
WED 22 • Q2 miss, slower contract growth, and a warning that AI-driven spending delays are hitting demand. The clearest "AI eats software" print of the week.			
04	ROL Rollins	n/a	-14.7%
WED 22 • EPS \$0.32 on \$1.08bn, both light, and the FY organic growth outlook cut on weak residential demand — despite a 99th straight quarter of revenue growth.			
05	TSLA Tesla	\$313.03	-14.5%
THU 23 • Worst earnings-reaction day on record. Record \$28.2bn revenue and 480,126 deliveries, but operating income fell 57%, margin hit 1.4%, FCF turned negative and capex heads past \$25bn. Down ~19% on the week.			
06	SNDK SanDisk	\$1,436.56	-11.0%
FRI 21 • Memory supply-glut fears as Samsung and SK Hynix add capacity. Still up ~526% YTD — this reads as profit-taking, not a broken thesis.			
07	MOH Molina Healthcare	n/a	-9.2%
THU 23 • Beat on EPS at \$1.51 but sold on falling membership and lower premium revenue. Health care is the only S&P sector shrinking this quarter.			
08	WDC Western Digital	\$558.30	-9.0%
FRI 24 • Same memory unwind; SK Hynix and Micron fell 6–8% alongside. Both ends of the round trip inside four sessions.			
09	INTC Intel	\$92.32	-8.0%
FRI 24 • Revenue \$16.1bn (+25%, fastest in 15 years), EPS \$0.42 versus \$0.21 est, data-centre and AI +59%. Popped 13% after hours, then gave it all back once capex above \$20bn landed.			
10	GOOGL Alphabet	= \$318	-7.1%
THU 23 • Worst earnings reaction since Feb 2025. Revenue \$119.8bn (+24%), Cloud +82%, 12th straight double-digit quarter — erased by FY capex guided to \$195–205bn and a warning that 2027 goes higher still.			

JUST MISSED
DPZ +7.0% (Mon, rose through an EPS miss) • EQT +6.6% (volume guidance raised) • HON +5% (FY outlook up) • CME +5% (best-ever first half) • AAPL +3.5% (Fri) • CRM +4.1%, IBM +3.6% (Fri, Dow leaders)

One name, both lists
Micron and Western Digital appear on opposite boards in the same week. Both rose about 12% on Tuesday as memory pricing ran, then fell 6–9% on Friday when Samsung and SK Hynix capacity additions revived glut fears. That round trip — not the Tesla headline — is the week's cleanest read on how thin the AI-hardware bid actually is: it is a positioning trade, and it unwinds in a session.

Backdrop

what set the tone

THE CAPEX VERDICT
Alphabet lifted FY26 capex to **\$195–205bn** (Q2 alone \$44.9bn, +101% y/y). Intel went past **\$20bn**. Tesla past **\$25bn**. All three beat; all three fell. Hyperscaler capex is tracking above **\$500bn** for 2026.

OIL AND THE GULF
Brent settled above **\$100** Thursday, +7% to \$100.69 and the highest since 22 May, after Houthi drone and missile strikes on two Saudi tankers. It slid to about **\$95** Friday on US–Iran talk hopes. Crude is up ~30% this month.

RATES ARE THE OTHER TAX
The 10-year sits at **4.67%**, touching ~4.70% — the highest since January 2025. Funds rate **3.50–3.75%**, with 2026 inflation projections revised up to 3.6% and Waller flagging risk tilted toward inflation.

EARNINGS, FLATTERED
Q2 blended S&P growth jumped to **37.9%** from 24.8% a week earlier — but Alphabet's GAAP figure carried a **\$98bn** one-off gain. Strip it out and the number is **25.9%**. Ten of eleven sectors are growing; health care is the exception.

UNDER THE SURFACE
Tech fell **2.37%** Friday while real estate, financials, materials, health care and staples rose — 17 S&P names hit 52-week highs, led by JPMorgan. Communication services and consumer discretionary each shed roughly 6% on the week.

NEXT WEEK DECIDES IT
FOMC 28–29 Jul, no dot plot, Chair Warsh at 2:30pm ET — a hold is expected but markets price roughly **35%** odds of a hike. Then Microsoft, Meta, Amazon, Apple and Qualcomm all report into the same capex question.

Crypto — ten largest

by market cap • separate from equities

Bitcoin and the majors

24 JUL • TOTAL CAP ~\$2.23TN

Retail & social layer REDDIT — HELD SEPARATE
This block is deliberately walled off from everything above. It is **chatter volume and vendor-computed sentiment**, not price or fundamental data, and it is not a source for any figure on the boards. Mention counts come from third-party scrapers polling r/wallstreetbets on short intervals, so rankings shift intraday and no two vendors agree exactly. Read it as a crowding indicator only. The percentages below are **change in mention volume over 24 hours**, not share of conversation, and the vendors sample different platforms — r/wallstreetbets, X, StockTwits, 4chan — so the two boards are not strictly like for like.

MOST DISCUSSED		
INTC The week's runaway topic. Mention volume spiked +591% to +751% in 24 hours depending on the snapshot, on the Q2 beat and the capex reversal. volume spike • direction mixed		
MOST BEARISH TSLA Sentiment tracked 24–36 of 100 after the print, with the 30-day score around 28 — firmly bearish. Cited: deliveries, margin collapse, executive departures, BYD charging. sentiment 28/100 • bearish		
BULLISH CLUSTER GOOG • NVDA • AMD Flagged bullish with strong AI scores even as GOOGL fell 7.1% on the tape — a clean case of the crowd and the price disagreeing. bullish • diverges from price		
ALSO TRENDING IBM • NOW Rounded out the top five most-talked-about names of 20–24 Jul across r/wallstreetbets and X, both on earnings. earnings-driven		
MENTION VOLUME — SHARPEST 24H SPIKES		
01	CPRT Copart	+1,167%
Largest single spike on the board — and not a name that moved on the tape this week.		
02	INTC Intel	+591% to +751%
The week's runaway topic, on the Q2 beat and the capex reversal. The range is two vendor snapshots.		
03	TSLA Tesla	+425%
Measured on 4chan /biz/. Sentiment 28/100 — heavy volume, firmly bearish.		
04	UBER Uber	+400%
On r/wallstreetbets. Another name absent from both mover boards.		
05	ORCL • NKE • MCD	sharp
Oracle, Nike and McDonald's all flagged as spiking; no percentage published for these three.		
HIGHEST ABSOLUTE VOLUME — A DIFFERENT MEASURE GOOG • NVDA • AMD were the most-mentioned names outright on 24 July, while INTC, TSLA, GOOGL, IBM and NOW were the five most discussed across the full week on r/wallstreetbets and X. Spike rank and volume rank are not the same thing: a name can top the spike list from a very low base, as Copart does here.		
Worth noting: the four names retail talked about most — INTC, TSLA, GOOGL, IBM — include three of the ten biggest decliners. Attention concentrated almost entirely on what was falling, and none of the week's actual top advances (UTZ, SMCI, ACHR, NBIS) registered in the top five by mention volume.		

How to read this. The headline percentage on each mover row is the **single-session reaction** to the catalyst named in each row, not full week-over-week returns, because that is how the underlying coverage reports them; the date chip on each row tells you which session. Where a figure was quoted intraday, after hours and at the close, the close is used and the others noted. A few percentages differ by one to two points between outlets covering the same move (SMCI was reported at +13%, +15%, +18% and +25% across venues and sessions) — the most widely corroborated figure is shown. Bars are scaled to a shared 0–90% range across both boards, so the two sides are directly comparable. Green and red never carry meaning alone; every value keeps its sign and every row sits in a labelled board. Compiled Saturday 25 July 2026 from the sources below; nothing here is investment advice.

Data notes — crypto and social buzz

Crypto figures are close-of-24-July snapshots gathered from published market reports, not from an exchange feed. Prices for the same coin varied slightly between outlets and the most widely corroborated value is shown; SOL appears at \$75.09 and \$75.42 across sources, and its daily fall as both 2.83% and 3.8%. Weekly moves are only shown where a source stated one — four of the nine carry n/a rather than an inferred figure, and the tenth constituent is left open because no source in reach ranked it.

Social buzz is chatter volume, not price or fundamental data, and is never a source for any figure on the equity or crypto boards. Each percentage is the change in mention volume over 24 hours as computed by a third-party scraper. Vendors poll different platforms on 5–15 minute intervals, so ranks shift intraday and no two agree exactly; the INTC range is two snapshots of the same day. A spike is measured against that name's own recent baseline, so a low-volume ticker can post a very large percentage — Copart's +1,167% is the clearest example, and it did not move on the tape.

Equity mover percentages above are single-session reactions to the catalyst named in each row, separately sourced, and unaffected by either of the above.

SOURCES — 61 TOTAL, REDDIT AND SOCIAL LISTED SEPARATELY

INDICES, SESSIONS & WEEKLY WRAP (1–11)

- Motley Fool — Stock Market Today, July 24
- Motley Fool — Midday, July 24
- TheStreet — Market Today, July 24
- CNBC — Market news, July 24
- Yahoo Finance — Friday live blog
- Trading Economics — US index
- Vantage — S&P 500, July 24
- Investrade — Market Review, July 24
- Investrade — Mid-Morning Look
- Trefis — 17 S&P 52-week highs
- Bloomberg — Futures steady, oil below \$100

DAILY MOVERS LISTS (12–19)

- CNBC — Midday movers, Jul 24
- CNBC — Premarket movers, Jul 24
- CNBC — Midday movers, Jul 23
- CNBC — Midday movers, Jul 22
- CNBC — Midday movers, Jul 21
- CNBC — Premarket movers, Jul 21
- CNBC — Midday movers, Jul 20
- CNBC — Premarket movers, Jul 20
- CNBC — Tesla Q2 2026
- Electrek — Tesla sheds \$140bn
- Teslarati — Tesla Q2 results
- CNBC — Alphabet Q2 takeaways
- Investing.com — Alphabet call transcript
- CNBC — Intel Q2 2026
- Yahoo — Intel falls 8% on a beat
- CNBC — IBM Q2 2026
- ServiceNow — Q2 results release
- Investing.com — ServiceNow transcript

- CNBC — Super Micro surges 15%
- Yahoo — SMCI \$60bn backlog
- FXLeaders — SMCI margin reset
- CNBC — Nebius +19% on Nvidia stake
- Bloomberg — Leslie's weighs Chapter 11
- Seeking Alpha — Leslie's sinks
- CNBC — Albertsons plunges
- TheStreet — Albertsons -22%
- Benzinga — Rollins downbeat Q2
- Benzinga — Molina membership decline

SEMI, MEMORY, APPLE & MACRO (40–50)

- 24/7 Wall St — Memory selloff
- Motley Fool — Why SanDisk dropped
- Benzinga — TXN slips on a double beat
- Motley Fool — Why Apple is up
- TipRanks — Apple upgrades
- FactSet — Earnings update, Jul 24
- CNN — Oil tops \$100, Red Sea
- CNBC — Oil after tanker attacks
- Federal Reserve — H.15 rates
- CNBC — Week ahead, Jul 27–31
- Seeking Alpha — Catalyst watch, FOMC

CRYPTO (51–57)

- Forbes Advisor — Top 10 cryptocurrencies, Jul 24
- Nexo — Markets Today, Jul 24
- CoinGape — Market brief, Jul 24
- CryptoTicker — BTC holds \$64k
- KuCoin — Daily market report, Jul 24
- CryptoPotato — ETH, XRP, ADA, BNB analysis
- INN — Crypto market recap
- REDDIT & SOCIAL — SEPARATE, NOT USED FOR ANY PRICE FIGURE (R1–R12)

- Benzinga — 5 most-discussed, Jul 20–24
- AltIndex — r/wallstreetbets mentions
- AltIndex — Reddit trending stocks
- Tradestie — WSB most active
- ApeWisdom — WSB trending
- Sirius Investors — Reddit sentiment
- 24/7 Wall St — Reddit bearish on Tesla
- Stocktwits — SMCI backlog chatter
- AltIndex — Trending across Reddit, X, StockTwits
- AltIndex — 4chan /biz/ tickers
- AltIndex — StockTwits most discussed
- AltIndex — Meme ticker activity